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ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

Clubs, Leadership and Volunteering: Build Skills Without Losing Your Semester

Choose activities that develop you and still leave room for your degree

CAMPUS LIFE

Campus Life

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Free to download. No fee, no payment step, no watermark.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

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Why this pack exists

Extracurricular activity can build real skills or quietly consume your study time. This pack helps you choose a small number of commitments deliberately, contribute well, and record what you learn in a way that later helps with internships and job applications.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Choose activities aligned with your goals and available time.
- Contribute effectively in a team and handle responsibility reliably.
- Balance leadership roles with academic workload.
- Record achievements and skills for future applications.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Choose deliberately

Depth in two activities beats shallow membership in eight.

- Decide what you want to develop: communication, organisation, technical skill or a network.
- Attend a meeting before committing to a role.
- Ask current members how much time the role actually takes.
- Check that meetings do not clash with core lectures or labs.
- Prefer organisations with clear structures and real projects.
- Leave gracefully if an activity is consuming your study time.

Work well in a team

Reliability is the most valued trait in student teams.

- Confirm what you own and when it is due.
- Communicate early when a deadline is at risk.
- Write brief minutes with decisions and owners.
- Do the unglamorous tasks sometimes; it builds trust.
- Give credit publicly and correct privately.
- Document events with photos and simple reports for continuity.

> **Leadership is not a title**
> A treasurer who keeps clean records and a volunteer who shows up consistently are doing more leadership than a titleholder who disappears.

Record what you learn

Experience that cannot be described is hard to use later.

- Keep a simple log: role, dates, tasks, results and skills used.
- Quantify where possible: number of participants, funds raised, sessions organised.
- Collect one or two references from supervisors.
- Save certificates and photographs in a folder.
- Reflect on one failure each semester and what you changed.
- Turn the log into CV bullet points while details are fresh.

Why joining one thing well beats five things badly

Student organisations are where leadership is actually practised: organising an event, managing a budget, resolving a disagreement, recruiting and replacing people. These are the experiences employers and postgraduate selectors ask about, and they are only credible when you can describe something you actually did.

Choose by interest and by the quality of the existing members. A well-run small society teaches more than a large disorganised one. Attend two meetings before committing, and ask what the group achieved last year - not what it plans to achieve.

Depth beats breadth. Two years in one organisation with a progression from member to coordinator to officer is a stronger story than one semester in six groups.

Running something: the basic mechanics